

Skills Summary

Choosing a Fast Way to Add Within 10

Use this reference while completing your worksheet or when studying.

Three fast ways cover almost every fact within ten. Before you add, **look at the two parts** and ask which way fits.

1. Count on from the larger part

Use it when: one part is small (1, 2, or 3) and the other is not.

How: hold the *larger* part in your head. Say the **next** number first, one number for each of the smaller part. Stop when you have said that many numbers.

Order never changes a sum, so you may always start from the larger part.

Example: $5 + 3$

Step 1. One part is only 3, so counting on is faster than counting all — hold the larger part, 5.

Step 2. Say the next three numbers: “6, 7, 8.” Three counts, one for each of the 3. $5 + 3 = 8$

Try it: $7 + 1$

check: 8

2. Use a double or a near double

Use it when: the two parts are the same, or are neighbours.

Doubles within ten: $1+1=2$, $2+2=4$, $3+3=6$, $4+4=8$, $5+5=10$.

Near double: neighbours are a double *and one more*. Use the double of the *smaller* part, then add 1.

Example: $3 + 4$

Step 1. The parts are neighbours, so reach for the double you already know instead of counting.

Step 2. Double the smaller part: $3 + 3 = 6$. The other part is one bigger, so add one more: $6 + 1 = 7$. $3 + 4 = 7$

Try it: $2 + 3$

check: 5

3. Make ten with ten-partners

Use it when: the two parts fill a whole ten-frame together.

The ten-partners: 1 and 9, 2 and 8, 3 and 7, 4 and 6, 5 and 5.

Learn these as *pairs*, both ways round. Then a missing part is a lookup, not a count: if one part is 6, the partner is 4.

Example: $3 + 7$

Step 1. These two parts are a ten-partner pair, so the frame fills exactly — recall beats counting on seven.

Step 2. On a ten-frame, 3 counters leave 7 empty spaces; filling them completes the frame.
 $3 + 7 = 10$

Try it: $8 + 2$

check:

(!) Watch out: when you count on, do *not* say the number you are holding as your first count. Holding 6 and adding 2, say “7, 8” — saying “6, 7” lands you one too low every time.